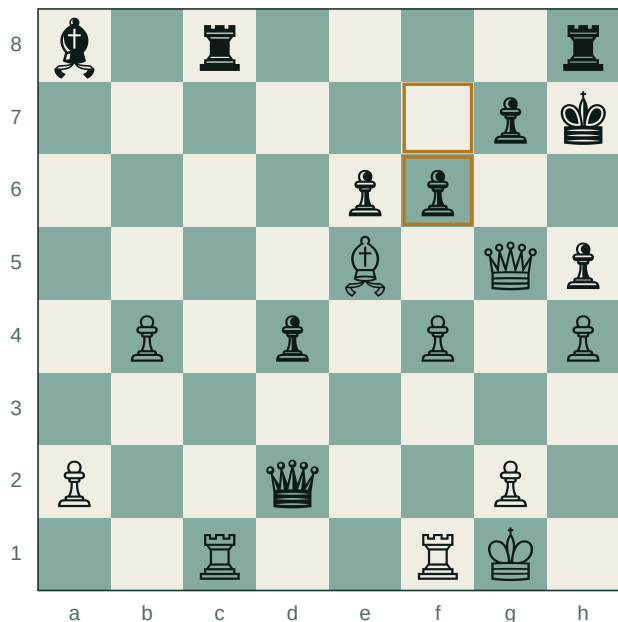


Interference tactics: White, move 31

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 30...f6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31. Qxh5+ Kg8 32. Rxc8#

31.Qxh5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h5. Recorded reply: **31...Kg8**.

32.Rxc8# Mate: rook on c8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on c8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2. Check for tactical protection.